

ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL (style)
ACADEX PRACTICE EXAMINATION
O-LEVEL · ENGLISH LANGUAGE

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1122/2
PAPER 2 November 2023

2 hours

PAPER 2 — READING — COMPREHENSION, SUMMARY, REGISTER — 2 HOURS

These are **original ACADEX questions** written to match ZIMSEC syllabus structure, mark allocations and command words. They are **not** leaked or copied official papers. This script is unique to November 2023 1122/2.

Additional materials: The passage is printed in this paper. Dictionaries may NOT be used.

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer all questions. Spend about 1 hour 30 minutes on Section A (comprehension and summary) and 30 minutes on Section B (register).

SECTION A (40 marks) — Comprehension and summary

PASSAGE

Table four<<
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>>The library was a rectangle of quiet in a school that lived by the bell. Miss Dube ruled it without shouting. She had a stamp, a register, and a look that could stop a joke in the doorway. Tendai hovered at the counter with money that was not enough for a library card. He had counted the coins in the boys' toilets so that no one would see how few they were.<<
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>>"I can read here and not take books home," he offered, as if bargaining with a kombi conductor. Miss Dube considered him. She knew his record: late sometimes, never rude, marks that jumped when a teacher lent him a set book. "The rule is the rule," she said, and Tendai's face closed like a book with no blurb. Then she added, "But rules can have annexes." She wrote his name in a small notebook of her own, not the official one. "You may sit at table four for two weeks. If you return every spine as you found it, we will talk about the card."<<
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>>Table four faced a poster of a child reading under a msasa tree, the kind of poster printed in another country and faded by Zimbabwean light. Tendai did not care. He had Animal Farm in his hands — the school copy, covers soft as cloth. He read as if eating. At the end of the period he waited for the others to leave so that he could align the chair exactly.<<
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>>On the tenth day Miss Dube placed a card on the table. It had his name in black ink and a stamp that was slightly crooked. "I paid the difference," she said, before he could invent a speech. "Do not thank me with words. Thank me by not disappearing when the examinations end. Libraries are for after the report book as well." Tendai nodded, which was all the English he could trust. Outside, someone rang the bell for the next lesson. He put the card in his shirt pocket, over his heart, because there was no other pocket he was willing to trust.

2. (a) Why does Tendai not simply buy a library card? [2]<<
>>(b) What do we learn about Tendai as a learner before Miss Dube helps him? [3]<<
>>(c) Explain "rules can have annexes". [3]<<
>>(d) How does Tendai show he deserves the chance she gives him? [4]<<
>>(e) What does Miss Dube want in return besides thanks? [4]<<
>>(f) Why does he put the card over his heart? [4] **[20]**
3. In not more than 160 words, summarise how Tendai gets access to the library and what Miss Dube expects. [20] **[20]**

SECTION B (10 marks) — Register · Answer ALL

4. A shop assistant short-changes you. The appropriate register is: **[2]**

- A) Excuse me, I think the change is not correct. Could we check, please?
- B) Whatever, keep it, poor people.
- C) You thieves!
- D) Give me my money before I call the police, now!

5. At a funeral, a neighbour is grieving. You should say: **[2]**

- A) I'm sorry for your loss. I am here with you.
- B) Let's discuss the will.
- C) At least they were old.
- D) You'll get over it.

6. You answer a landline in an office. The proper opening is: **[2]**

- A) Yes?
- B) Talk, I'm listening.
- C) Good morning, Mutasa High School, may I help you?
- D) Who is this?

7. A classmate borrows your pen and does not return it. You say: **[2]**

- A) You always steal.
- B) May I have my pen back, please? I need it for the next lesson.
- C) I'm telling the whole school.
- D) Buy your own, beggar.

8. A tourist in your town asks if it is 'safe'. The most appropriate reply is: **[2]**

- A) Why, are you scared?
- B) I don't talk to foreigners.
- C) Generally yes, but keep your bag closed and use registered taxis.
- D) This place is a jungle, run.

END OF QUESTION PAPER

Worked solutions and mark-scheme notes are inside the ACADEX app (Extract & Study).